Latin Declension & Conjugation ID Sheet

STEP 1 Find the declension from the genitive singular

Declension	Gen. sg.	Examples (nom., gen.)	Usual gender
1st	-ae	puella, puellae	feminine (a few masc.: agricola, nauta, poēta)
2nd	-ī	servus, servī · puer, puerī · ager, agrī · bellum, bellī	masculine (-us, -er), neuter (-um)
3rd	-is	rēx, rēgis · corpus, corporis · urbs, urbis	any: learn it with the word
4th	-ūs	frūctus, frūctūs · cornū, cornūs	masculine (fem.: manus, domus), neuter (-ū)
5th	-eī / -ēī	rēs, reī · diēs, diēī	feminine (diēs usually masc.)

The nominative can fool you (-us is 2nd, 3rd, or 4th). The genitive never does. Always learn nouns as nominative + genitive + gender.

STEP 2 Match the ending

	1st	2nd m.	2nd n.	3rd m./f.	3rd n.	4th m.	4th n.	5th
Nom. sg.	-a	-us / -er	-um	(varies)	(varies)	-us	-ū	-ēs
Gen. sg.	-ae	-ī	-ī	-is	-is	-ūs	-ūs	-eī
Dat. sg.	-ae	-ō	-ō	-ī	-ī	-uī	-ū	-eī
Acc. sg.	-am	-um	-um	-em	= nom.	-um	-ū	-em
Abl. sg.	-ā	-ō	-ō	-e	-e	-ū	-ū	-ē
Nom. pl.	-ae	-ī	-a	-ēs	-a	-ūs	-ua	-ēs
Gen. pl.	-ārum	-ōrum	-ōrum	-um	-um	-uum	-uum	-ērum
Dat. pl.	-īs	-īs	-īs	-ibus	-ibus	-ibus	-ibus	-ēbus
Acc. pl.	-ās	-ōs	-a	-ēs	-a	-ūs	-ua	-ēs
Abl. pl.	-īs	-īs	-īs	-ibus	-ibus	-ibus	-ibus	-ēbus

- **Neuter rule:** nominative = accusative, and the nom./acc. plural always ends in -a.
- **Vocative** = nominative, except 2nd-decl. -us → -e (Mārce) and -ius → -ī (fīlī).
- **3rd-decl. i-stems:** gen. pl. -ium (urbium); acc. pl. sometimes -īs (omnīs = omnēs). Neuter i-stems (mare, animal): abl. sg. -ī, nom./acc. pl. -ia.
- **5th decl.:** -ēī after a vowel (diēī), -eī after a consonant (reī).

STEP 3 Ending lookup: what could this ending be?

Ending	Possible IDs
-a	1st nom. sg. · neuter nom./acc. pl. (-ā = 1st abl. sg.)
-ae	1st gen. sg. · dat. sg. · nom. pl.
-e / -ē	-e 3rd abl. sg. · 3rd neuter nom./acc. sg. (mare) · 2nd voc. sg. (Mārce) · -ē 5th abl. sg. (rē, diē)
-em	3rd or 5th acc. sg.
-ēs	3rd nom./acc. pl. · 3rd nom. sg. of some nouns (nūbēs) · 5th nom. sg., nom./acc. pl.
-ī	2nd gen. sg. · 2nd masc. nom. pl. · 2nd voc. sg. of -ius nouns (fīlī) · 3rd dat. sg. · 3rd neuter i-stem abl. sg. (marī)
-is / -īs	-is 3rd gen. sg. · 3rd nom. sg. of many nouns (cīvis, hostis, nāvis) · -īs 1st/2nd dat./abl. pl. · 3rd i-stem acc. pl. (omnīs)

Ending	Possible IDs
-ō	2nd dat./abl. sg.
-um	2nd acc. sg. (m.) · 2nd nom./acc. sg. (n.) · 3rd gen. pl. · 4th acc. sg.
-us / -ūs	-us 2nd nom. sg. · 3rd neuter nom./acc. sg. (corpus, tempus) · 4th nom. sg. · -ūs 4th gen. sg., nom./acc. pl. · 3rd nom. sg. (virtūs, salūs)
-ibus	3rd/4th dat./abl. pl.
-ārum · -ōrum · -ērum	gen. pl. (1st · 2nd · 5th)
-uum	4th gen. pl.
-ēbus	5th dat./abl. pl.

STEP 4 Ask what the case is doing

Case	Common uses
Nominative	subject; predicate noun/adjective after *est, sunt*
Genitive	"of": possession, part of a whole (*pars mīlitum*), description
Dative	"to / for": indirect object; with special verbs (*crēdō, pāreō, persuādeō*) and certain adjectives
Accusative	direct object; place to which (*ad, in* + acc.); duration of time (*trēs hōrās*); subject of an indirect statement
Ablative	"by, with, from, in, on": means (*gladiō*), manner (*cum cūrā*), personal agent (*ā/ab* + abl.), time when (*prīmā lūce*), place where (*in* + abl.), separation, ablative absolute
Vocative	direct address (*Et tū, Brūte?*)

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Latin Declension & Conjugation ID Sheet

STEP 1 Find the conjugation from the first two principal parts

Conjugation	1st & 2nd principal parts	Tell-tale	Present stem
1st	amō, amāre	-āre	amā-
2nd	moneō, monēre	-eō, -ēre (long ē)	monē-
3rd	dūcō, dūcere	-ō, -ere (short e)	dūc(e)-
3rd -iō	capiō, capere	-iō + -ere	capi-
4th	audiō, audīre	-iō + -īre	audī-

No macrons in your book? Check the first principal part: -eō means 2nd conjugation; a plain -ō with -ere means 3rd.

STEP 2 Read the personal ending (who?)

	I	you (sg.)	he/she/it	we	you (pl.)	they
Active	-ō / -m	-s	-t	-mus	-tis	-nt
Passive	-r / -or	-ris / -re	-tur	-mur	-minī	-ntur
Perfect active	-ī	-istī	-it	-imus	-istis	-ērunt / -ēre

STEP 3 Find the tense and mood sign (when? fact or not?)

Tense / mood	Sign	1st	2nd	3rd	3rd -iō	4th
Present indicative	stem + ending	amat	monet	dūcit	capit	audit
Imperfect indicative	-bā-	amābat	monēbat	dūcēbat	capiēbat	audiēbat
Future indicative	-bi- (1st, 2nd) · -ē-, 1st sg. -am (3rd, 4th)	amābit	monēbit	dūcet	capiet	audiet
Perfect indicative	perfect stem + perfect endings	amāvit	monuit	dūxit	cēpit	audīvit
Pluperfect indicative	perfect stem + -erā-	amāverat	monuerat	dūxerat	cēperat	audīverat
Future perfect	perfect stem + -eri- (1st sg. -erō)	amāverit	monuerit	dūxerit	cēperit	audīverit
Present subjunctive	-e- (1st) · -a- (all others)	amet	moneat	dūcat	capiat	audiat
Imperfect subjunctive	present infinitive + ending	amāret	monēret	dūceret	caperet	audīret
Perfect subjunctive	perfect stem + -eri- (1st sg. -erim)	amāverit	monuerit	dūxerit	cēperit	audīverit
Pluperfect subjunctive	perfect infinitive + ending (-isse-)	amāvisset	monuisset	dūxisset	cēpisset	audīvisset

Passive: the present, imperfect, and future use the same signs with passive endings (amābātur, dūcētur). The perfect system uses the perfect passive participle + sum: amātus est (perf.), erat (plupf.), erit (fut. perf.), sit (perf. subj.), esset (plupf. subj.).

Present-subjunctive vowels by conjugation: **wE fEAr A lIAr**. amEt · monEAt · dūcAt · capIAt · audIAt

STEP 4 Non-finite forms (from amō)

Form	Latin	Meaning
Pres. act. inf.	amāre	to love
Pres. pass. inf.	amārī	to be loved (3rd: dūcī, capī)
Perf. act. inf.	amāvisse	to have loved
Perf. pass. inf.	amātus esse	to have been loved
Fut. act. inf.	amātūrus esse	to be about to love
Pres. act. part.	amāns, amantis	loving
Perf. pass. part.	amātus, -a, -um	(having been) loved
Fut. act. part.	amātūrus, -a, -um	about to love
Gerundive	amandus, -a, -um	to be loved, must be loved
Gerund	amandī, -ō, -um, -ō	(of / for / by) loving — verbal noun
Supine	amātum · amātū	to love (purpose, after motion) · to love (with adj.: mīrābile dictū)
Imperative	amā, amāte	love! (nōlī/nōlīte + inf. = don't). Short forms: dīc, dūc, fac, fer

STEP 5 Watch for look-alikes

- monet = present (2nd) · dūcet = future (3rd) · amet = present subjunctive (1st). Same -et, three different IDs. **Find the conjugation first.**
- dūcam, audiam: future *or* present subjunctive (1st sg.). Context decides.
- āmāverit: future perfect *or* perfect subjunctive. Only the 1st sg. differs in spelling (āmāverō / āmāverim); the grammars also give the perf. subj. a long ī in -erīs, -erīmus, -erītis.
- amāvēre on a *perfect* stem = amāvērunt, not an infinitive.
- amāre: present infinitive *or* 2nd sg. present passive (= amāris).
- -re- between stem and ending (dūceret) = imperfect subjunctive.
- Vowel length can be the only clue: venit (comes) / vēnit (came); legit / lēgit.
- sum at a glance: est, erat, erit, fuit, sit, esset.

Want help putting this into practice? Book a free 20-minute consultation: **cal.com/jacob-lubert-latin**

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